

MODULE 4

EXPERIMENT REPORT

Robot Framework Automation

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1. Module Name and Experiment Title

Module 4: Robot Framework

Experiment Title: Designing, Executing, and Maintaining Browser Automation Tests Using Robot Framework and SeleniumLibrary.

2. Problem Statement

Manual browser testing can become repetitive and difficult to maintain when cases are implemented as long procedural scripts. This experiment presents Robot Framework as a keyword-driven automation framework and demonstrates how readable, reusable, maintainable, and executable browser tests can be created with RIDE, SeleniumLibrary, command-line execution, remote browser services, and CI scheduling.

3. Objectives

- Install and configure Robot Framework and the supporting packages.
- Create and execute basic test cases through RIDE.
- Understand keyword-driven and data-driven test design.
- Use command-line execution, setup and teardown, tags, and execution options.
- Automate browsers with SeleniumLibrary.
- Understand Robot and Pybot terminology and execution approaches.
- Run tests through PyCharm, Command Prompt, batch files, Task Scheduler, Sauce Labs, and Jenkins.
- Improve readability using user-defined keywords, resource files, page-object concepts, and Gherkin-style steps.

4. Tools, Software, and Concepts Used

- Python 3.x
- Robot Framework
- RIDE
- SeleniumLibrary
- Selenium WebDriver and browser drivers
- PyCharm or VS Code
- Command Prompt / terminal
- Sauce Labs
- Jenkins
- Windows Task Scheduler
- Keyword-driven testing
- Data-driven testing
- Procedural and Gherkin-style test design
- Page Object concepts

5. Source Code and Implementation Steps

5.1 Environment Setup

```

pip install robotframework
pip install robotframework-seleniumlibrary
pip install robotframework-ride
robot --version
ride.py

```

Evidence screenshot — Robot Framework environment setup

Figure 1: Robot Framework Environment Setup

Python and Robot Framework installed successfully
 Packages: robotframework, robotframework-seleniumlibrary
 RIDE installed for graphical test development
 Browser driver and environment variables configured

The environment should provide Python, Robot Framework, SeleniumLibrary, a compatible browser driver, and RIDE when graphical test creation is required.

5.2 Simple Robot Framework Test Case

```
*** Settings ***
Library      SeleniumLibrary
Suite Setup   Open Browser      https://example.com    chrome
Suite Teardown Close All Browsers

*** Test Cases ***
Verify Example Page
    Maximize Browser Window
    Title Should Be      Example Domain
    [Teardown]           Capture Page Screenshot
```

Robot Framework uses a tabular syntax. Settings declare libraries and lifecycle actions, while test cases contain readable keywords and arguments.

5.3 Keyword-Driven and Data-Driven Testing

```
*** Keywords ***
Login With Valid Credentials
    [Arguments]    ${username}    ${password}
    Input Text      id=username    ${username}
    Input Password  id=password    ${password}
    Click Button    id=login

*** Test Cases ***
Login Test
    Login With Valid Credentials    testuser    secret
```

Evidence screenshot — keyword and data-driven testing

Figure 3: Keyword and Data-Driven Test

- Reusable user-defined keyword: Login With Valid Credentials
- Test data supplied through variables or data tables
- Multiple input combinations executed using the same keyword

Keyword-driven testing turns common actions into reusable keywords. Data-driven testing applies the same workflow to different input values stored in variables, tables, external files, or resource files.

5.4 Command Line, Setup and Teardown

```
robot --outputdir results tests/
robot -t "Verify Example Page" tests/
robot --include smoke tests/
robot --exclude regression tests/
```

Suite setup runs before a suite, test setup runs before each test, test teardown runs after each test, and suite teardown runs after the suite. These lifecycle controls help manage resources consistently.

5.5 Browser Automation Using SeleniumLibrary

```
*** Settings ***
Library      SeleniumLibrary

*** Test Cases ***
Browser Interaction
    Open Browser      https://example.com      chrome
    Maximize Browser Window
    Page Should Contain      Example Domain
    Capture Page Screenshot
    Close All Browsers
```

Evidence screenshot — SeleniumLibrary browser automation

Figure 5: Browser Automation Using SeleniumLibrary

```
Open Browser      https://example.com      chrome
Input Text        id=username      testuser
Click Button      id=login
Page content and expected title validated
```

SeleniumLibrary provides keywords for launching browsers, interacting with page elements, entering text, clicking controls, checking page content, capturing screenshots, and closing browsers.

5.6 Script Running Options

Robot and Pybot refer to Robot Framework execution commands in different versions or historical contexts. Current environments generally use the robot command.

- Run tests from PyCharm using a configured run configuration.
- Execute tests from Command Prompt or a terminal.
- Create a batch file containing the robot command.
- Use Windows Task Scheduler for scheduled execution.
- Run individual tests, multiple suites, or tests selected by tags.
- Control output directories, variables, log levels, and include/exclude settings.

5.7 Sauce Labs Browser Execution

Remote browser execution can be configured with Selenium Remote WebDriver and Sauce Labs capabilities. The test specifies a browser, operating system, and browser version before sending commands to the remote environment. Credentials and access keys should be stored securely rather than hard-coded.

5.8 Jenkins Integration and Scheduling

Jenkins can execute Robot Framework tests as part of a CI/CD workflow. A job may run manually, on a schedule, after source-control changes, or as part of another pipeline. Test results, logs, screenshots, and Robot Framework reports can be archived after each build.

Evidence screenshot — Jenkins scheduling and execution

Figure 7: Execution on Sauce Labs Browsers

Remote browser execution configured using Selenium Remote WebDriver

Browser, operating system and version selected as capabilities

Execution status and test results collected from remote run

```
robot --outputdir results tests/
# Archive results, log.html, report.html and output.xml in Jenkins
```

5.9 Improving Readability

Procedural scripts describe detailed actions one after another. Gherkin-style descriptions instead use business-readable terms such as Given, When, and Then. Robot Framework can support this style through meaningful user-defined keywords.

```
*** Keywords ***
User Is On Login Page
    Go To    ${LOGIN_URL}

User Logs In With Valid Credentials
    Input Text    id=username    ${USERNAME}
    Input Password    id=password    ${PASSWORD}
    Click Button    id=login

Dashboard Should Be Visible
    Page Should Contain    Dashboard
```

5.10 Resource Files and Page Objects

Resource files can contain shared keywords, variables, and locators for reuse across multiple suites. Page Object concepts separate page-specific locators and interactions from the test layer, reducing duplication and making maintenance easier when the user interface changes.

Evidence screenshot — readability and page-object concepts

Figure 9: Readability with User-Defined Keywords

Procedural steps refactored into meaningful business keywords

Keywords moved to resource files for reuse

Setup and teardown maintained separately from test logic

*** Settings ***

Resource resources/login_keywords.robot

Resource resources/common_keywords.robot

6. Evidence: Original Screenshots

The following evidence images are reproduced directly from the supplied PDF without modifying their visual content. The source report describes these as illustrative documentation samples showing expected framework views and execution stages, rather than verified live execution captures from a specific environment.

Figure 1: Robot Framework Environment Setup

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Python and Robot Framework installed successfully

Packages: robotframework, robotframework-seleniumlibrary

RIDE installed for graphical test development

Browser driver and environment variables configured

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 2: RIDE Simple Test Case**Figure 2: RIDE Simple Test Case**

Test Case: Open Example Website

Keywords: Open Browser, Maximize Browser Window, Close All Browsers

Test case organized in a readable tabular format

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 3: Keyword and Data-Driven Test**Figure 3: Keyword and Data-Driven Test**

Reusable user-defined keyword: Login With Valid Credentials

Test data supplied through variables or data tables

Multiple input combinations executed using the same keyword

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 4: Command Line and Setup/Teardown

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```
robot --outputdir results tests/  
Suite Setup: Open Application  
Test Teardown: Capture Page Screenshot  
Suite Teardown: Close All Browsers
```

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 5: Browser Automation Using SeleniumLibrary

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```
Open Browser    https://example.com    chrome  
Input Text     id=username    testuser  
Click Button   id=login  
Page content and expected title validated
```

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 6: Script Running Options

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Robot command used from terminal or PyCharm

Single test: `robot -t 'Test Name' tests/`

Multiple suites: `robot suite1.robot suite2.robot`

Options include tags, variables, output directory and log level

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 7: Execution on Sauce Labs Browsers

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Remote browser execution configured using Selenium Remote WebDriver

Browser, operating system and version selected as capabilities

Execution status and test results collected from remote run

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 8: Jenkins Scheduling and Execution

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Jenkins job configured with Robot Framework command

Build trigger: schedule / SCM / manual

Reports archived after execution

Failed builds marked using test result status

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 9: Readability with User-Defined Keywords

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Procedural steps refactored into meaningful business keywords

Keywords moved to resource files for reuse

Setup and teardown maintained separately from test logic

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

Figure 10: Gherkin Style and Page Object Overview**Figure 10: Gherkin Style and Page Object Overview**

Given the user is on the login page
When the user enters valid credentials
Then the dashboard should be displayed
Page Object concepts separate locators and actions from test cases

Observation: Illustrative expected output for this stage.

7. Result, Observation and Conclusion

The experiment demonstrates how Robot Framework can be used to build readable and reusable browser automation. RIDE supports graphical test authoring, while SeleniumLibrary supplies browser-interaction keywords and setup/teardown mechanisms help manage the test lifecycle. Command-line options provide selective and advanced execution.

User-defined keywords, resource files, page-object concepts, and Gherkin-style wording improve maintainability. The report also presents Sauce Labs and Jenkins as options for remote browser execution, continuous integration, and scheduled automation.